

POSTRES BORICUAS

Los dulces de la isla

Five classic island desserts — coconut, corn, and comfort, from tembleque to arroz con dulce.

Mainland-tested · From the Ortiz kitchen

Hecho con corazón y sofrito · sofritostudio.com

Tembleque — Puerto Rican Coconut Milk Pudding Recipe

Tembleque

A coconut milk pudding that literally jiggles — the holiday dessert on every Puerto Rican Christmas table.

Ingredients

- 2 cans (13.5 oz) coconut milk
- 1/2 cup cornstarch
- 1/2 cup sugar
- 1/4 teaspoon salt
- Ground cinnamon for dusting

Steps

1. In a small bowl, whisk the cornstarch with 1/2 cup of the coconut milk until completely smooth with no lumps. Set aside.
2. Pour the remaining coconut milk into a medium saucepan. Add the sugar and salt. Heat over medium, stirring occasionally, until it reaches a gentle simmer.
3. Whisk the cornstarch mixture one more time, then slowly pour it into the simmering coconut milk, whisking constantly.
4. Continue cooking and whisking for 3-5 minutes until the mixture thickens to a pudding consistency. It should coat the back of a spoon.
5. Pour into a mold, bundt pan, or individual cups. Let cool to room temperature, then cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours until fully set.
6. To unmold, run a knife around the edges and invert onto a plate. Dust generously with ground cinnamon before serving.

Majarete — Authentic Puerto Rican Corn and Coconut Pudding Recipe

Majarete

Warm corn and coconut pudding — the humble, comforting dessert every Puerto Rican grandmother made.

Ingredients

- 1 cup cornmeal
- 2 cans (13.5 oz) coconut milk
- 1/2 cup sugar
- 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Pinch of salt
- Ground cinnamon for topping

Steps

1. Mix cornmeal with 1 can of coconut milk until smooth.
2. Heat the remaining coconut milk with sugar, cinnamon, and salt in a pot over medium heat.
3. Whisk the cornmeal mixture into the hot coconut milk.
4. Cook stirring constantly for 10-15 minutes until very thick.
5. Pour into cups and chill for 2 hours. Dust with cinnamon before serving.

Arroz con Dulce — Puerto Rican Sweet Coconut Rice Pudding Recipe

Arroz Con Dulce

Puerto Rico's sweet coconut rice pudding — the holiday dessert that's actually easy to make.

Ingredients

- 2 cups short-grain rice
- 2 cans (13.5 oz) coconut milk
- 1 can (14 oz) sweetened condensed milk
- 1 cup sugar
- 1/2 cup raisins
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- 1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

Steps

1. Rinse the rice under cold water until mostly clear.
2. Combine rice, coconut milk, condensed milk, sugar, raisins, cinnamon, and nutmeg in a heavy pot. Bring to a boil, stirring.
3. Reduce heat to low, cover, and cook 25 minutes without stirring.
4. Stir, then cook uncovered 15 more minutes until tender and creamy.
5. Add vanilla. Serve warm or chilled, dusted with cinnamon.

Besitos de Coco — Authentic Puerto Rican Coconut Macaroons Recipe

Besitos De Coco

Coconut macaroons shaped into little kisses — chewy, sweet, and impossibly simple.

Ingredients

- 3 cups sweetened shredded coconut
- 2 eggs
- 1/3 cup sugar
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of salt

Steps

1. Mix coconut, eggs, sugar, vanilla, and salt until combined.
2. Scoop tablespoon-sized mounds onto a parchment-lined baking sheet.
3. Bake at 325°F for 12-15 minutes until edges are golden.
4. Cool completely on the baking sheet.

Arepas de Coco — Authentic Puerto Rican Coconut Flour Fritters Recipe

Arepas De Coco

Coconut flour fritters — crispy, fluffy, and naturally gluten-free. A beach-favorite fritura from Puerto Rico.

Ingredients

- 1 cup coconut flour
- 1/2 cup shredded coconut
- 2 eggs
- 1/4 cup coconut milk
- 2 tablespoons sugar
- 1/2 teaspoon baking powder
- Pinch of salt
- Oil for frying

Steps

1. Mix coconut flour, shredded coconut, baking powder, and salt in a bowl.
2. Add eggs, coconut milk, and sugar. Mix until a thick batter forms.
3. Heat oil in a skillet over medium heat to about 350F.
4. Drop spoonfuls of batter into the hot oil. Fry 2-3 minutes per side until golden brown.
5. Drain on paper towels and serve warm.